

County Government

Requisition Approval Overview

PROCUREMENT GUIDE

What a requisition is, who approves it, typical thresholds, and best practices

What Is a Requisition?

County Government — Requisition Approval Overview

Definition

A purchase requisition initiates a county department's request to buy goods or services, subject to review by procurement staff and, for larger dollar amounts, the Board of County Commissioners.

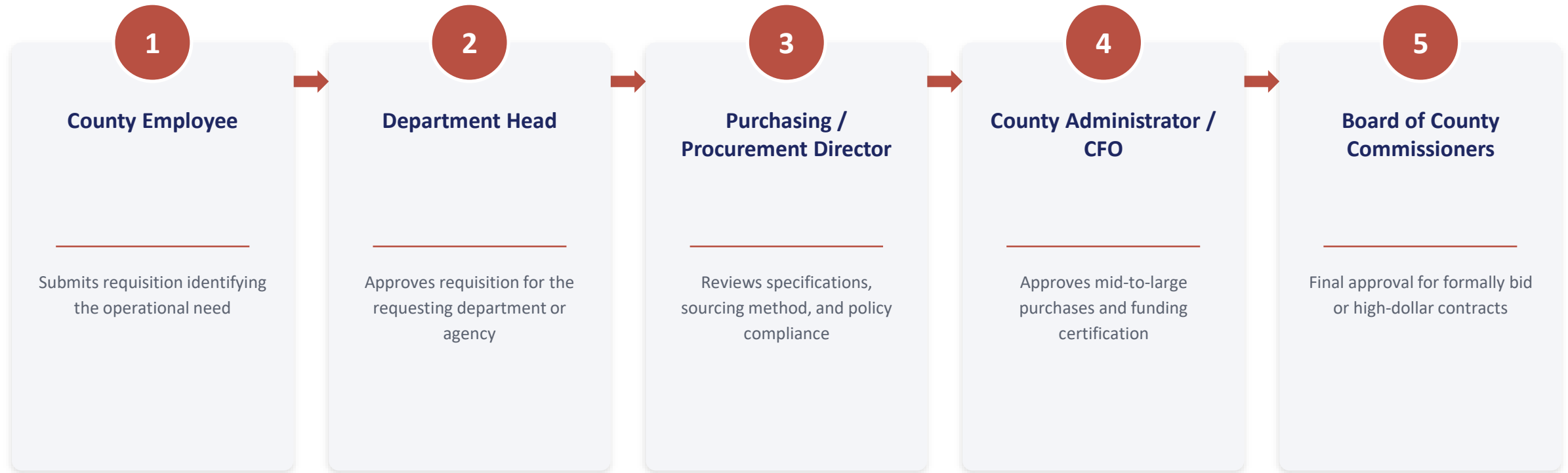
Why Approval Matters

- Protects county funds and supports fiscal accountability
- Ensures compliance with state procurement statutes
- Documents the need and justification for county auditors
- Enables competitive procurement for taxpayer value

Approval Hierarchy



Who reviews and approves a requisition, step by step



Structure reflects common practice within County Government; exact dollar thresholds are set by local policy.

Roles & Responsibilities



What each approver actually checks before signing off

County Employee

- Initiates the request
- Documents specifications and justification

Department Head

- Approves requisition for their department or agency
- Confirms the operational need

Purchasing / Procurement Director

- Reviews sourcing method and specifications
- Confirms vendor selection process and policy compliance

County Administrator / CFO

- Approves mid-to-large requisitions
- Certifies the funding source

Board of County Commissioners

- Grants final approval for formally bid contracts
- Authorizes high-dollar or long-term agreements

Typical Approval Thresholds

Illustrative dollar tiers seen in County Government purchasing policies

1

Micro-purchases (often up to about \$10,000) may be approved administratively without competitive bidding

2

Purchases in the tens of thousands commonly need Purchasing Director and Administrator sign-off

3

Formal competitive bids (often \$50,000+) require Board of Commissioners approval

4

Federally funded purchases carry additional compliance review

These figures are illustrative examples drawn from public purchasing policies, not a universal standard — always confirm the current thresholds in your own adopted policy.



Best Practices & Common Challenges

Lessons learned from running requisition approvals at scale

Best Practices

- Maintain a documented delegation-of-authority matrix by dollar tier
- Use e-procurement workflow tools to route and log approvals
- Require documented price comparisons below the formal bid threshold
- Align thresholds with state procurement statutes

Common Challenges

- Coordinating requisitions across independently elected offices (Sheriff, Clerk, etc.)
- Board meeting schedules can delay large purchases
- Federal grant compliance adds extra approval steps
- Emergency procurement requires strict after-the-fact documentation

Key Takeaways

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1 County approval hierarchy moves from department to executive to elected board oversight

2 Thresholds are typically set in county purchasing policy and state statute

3 The Purchasing/Procurement Director acts as the compliance checkpoint

4 Board approval is the final word on major contracts